

Chapter 19: Signing

That night was probably the first time in a long while that the two had shared the same bed.

Feng Yue fell asleep early due to drowsiness from taking her medicine, while Yan Lin lay on her side watching Feng Yue's sleeping face for nearly half the night.

When she left for the company the next morning, there were two faint dark circles under her eyes.

Feng Yue slept until after nine o'clock. When she came downstairs, Liu Ma had already prepared breakfast for her.

"Madam, here's your warm water."

"Thank you, Liu Ma."

Feng Yue ate her breakfast slowly, then said after a while: "By the way, Liu Ma, you don't need to prepare my lunch today. I'm going out."

"Yes, Madam."

After breakfast, Feng Yue went to the garage to pick out a car. She didn't want to call the driver for this trip.

The place Feng Yue was going to was quite a distance from the villa - it was the first property she had owned on her own after coming of age.

Songhe Bay¹ had an excellent location in Yanjing's most prosperous commercial district. It was a large flat on the fourteenth floor with a total area of over 220 square meters. Originally, her parents had suggested choosing something larger, but Feng Yue at that time thought that since she would eventually live in the small villa with Yan Lin anyway, there was no need to buy something so big.

Songhe Bay was one unit per elevator, accessed by card. So when the elevator doors opened, Feng Yue saw her entryway piled high with delivery boxes.

She had lived in this house for a while, so whether it was the decoration or furniture, everything was according to her preferences.

Since the house had been unoccupied for a long time, all the furniture was covered with dust covers. She knew she would be moving here soon, so today she had come specifically to clean up the house.

Feng Yue didn't want cleaning staff coming to her home, so she had to do it all herself.

The dining room and living room were connected, so she started cleaning these two areas first.

Near noon, Feng Yue ordered delivery from Yuxiang Zhai. After eating, she didn't continue cleaning but began dealing with the pile of packages that the building manager had delivered to her entryway.

After her recent livestream, Feng Yue's personal account had gained quite a few followers, and everyone had been asking when she would do a second livestream.

But Feng Yue didn't really want to livestream, mainly because once she started cooking during a livestream, she couldn't see the comments from viewers in the chat. So after discussing with Dai Shuangshuang, they decided to make videos instead.

Dai Shuangshuang had recently started school and didn't have time to help Feng Yue edit videos, so she began looking up tutorials online to learn by herself. After some time, she had roughly mastered some basic skills.

And the packages at her home now were things she had bought to prepare for making videos.

Cameras, tripods, a computer for video editing, kitchen utensils, and so on.

The electronic products like cameras and computers were all recommended by Dai Shuangshuang, while the kitchen items were all chosen by herself - simple and elegant, clearly very practical.

Originally, Feng Yue had been somewhat worried that she wouldn't do well, but later she figured it out herself.

She didn't care whether this could make money, so even if the videos were rough in the beginning, it didn't matter. What she needed was something she could focus on, and being a food blogger was currently a good choice for her.

She had depended on Yan Lin for too long, to the point where she had almost forgotten what it was like to live on her own. She needed other things to divert her attention.

During yesterday's dinner, while Yan Lin and Fu Sixue were away, Feng Yue had specifically consulted Wen Zhen about some questions regarding making videos.

It was only during yesterday's conversation that everyone learned Wen Zhen's family owned an entertainment company, and she herself had studied directing in college, so she was fairly knowledgeable about filming and editing.

Looking at the filming equipment in front of her that she couldn't make heads or tails of, Feng Yue contacted Wen Zhen somewhat embarrassedly.

Wen Zhen was very kind. Knowing that it couldn't be explained clearly over the phone, she arranged to spend a day helping Feng Yue look at everything in person.

Feng Yue was naturally delighted, since some very detailed questions couldn't be found answers to online.

Feng Yue hung up the phone and walked to the balcony, watching the sky outside turn a beautiful orange color.

She couldn't help but start looking forward to her new life.

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The family dinner that Feng Yue had arranged with Lady Yan quickly arrived. She had notified Yan Lin about this dinner very early.

Perhaps because there would be elders present, this time Yan Lin wasn't afraid at all of being alone with Feng Yue, because she thought Feng Yue wouldn't bring up divorce at the dinner table.

But the current Feng Yue was no longer the same Feng Yue as before. In her eyes, no one was more important than her family and herself.

Feng Yue had brought two sets of documents in her bag - these were all her weapons for tonight.

Feng Yue had been waiting in the private room early. As the agreed time approached, she began to feel somewhat nervous.

Her parents arrived first. As soon as the Feng couple entered, they saw their daughter and were naturally overjoyed.

"Nuan Nuan², Mom missed you so much." Lady Feng quickly threw her bag to Mr. Feng and came forward to give her daughter a big hug.

Feng Yue hugged her mother, then didn't forget about Mr. Feng who had a long face. After hugging him, his expression finally turned from cloudy to sunny.

"Mom, Dad, please sit first. Yan Lin and them should be here soon."

Before Feng Yue finished speaking, the private room door was pushed open again. This time it was Lady Yan and Mr. Yan.

The elders from both families were very close, and soon they were ignoring Feng Yue, the young person.

Watching the two families of elders chatting happily, Feng Yue felt something called guilt for the first time.

Even in her previous life, she had never suffered any grievances at the Yan family. Lady Yan was a quite open-minded and gentle elder who never said a harsh word to her no matter what happened.

Sometimes she couldn't understand how such an open and lively family like the Yans could have raised someone like Yan Lin, who was like an ice mountain snow lotus³.

Everyone was here except Yan Lin. There were five minutes left before Yan Lin would be late.

Feng Yue sighed quietly. She should have told Yan Lin an earlier appointment time.

She took out her phone, just about to call and ask, when the next second the private room door opened.

Yan Lin's figure appeared in the doorway. Her cheeks were somewhat red, her hair was a bit disheveled, and she was even breathing slightly hard.

"Mom, Dad, sorry I'm late." Even though Yan Lin looked slightly disheveled on the surface, her cool and calm voice was still the same as always.

Lady Feng could tell from her appearance that Yan Lin must have rushed here, so she quickly gestured for Feng Yue to pour her some water, saying: "You're not late, there's still some time. Sit down quickly, look how tired you are."

"It's rush hour now. If you knew there would be traffic, why didn't you leave earlier?" Mr. Yan frowned, seeming very dissatisfied with Yan Lin arriving just on time.

"I understand, I'll pay attention next time." Yan Lin nodded and obediently admitted her mistake, then sat down next to Feng Yue, taking the water Feng Yue poured for her and drinking a sip.

"Thank you."

Feng Yue nodded slightly, then signaled the server to start serving the food.

From the moment the server started bringing out dishes, Feng Yue became tense. Looking at the food on the table, she felt a bit regretful.

She knew that no one would have a good meal tonight.

After the servers left, just as everyone was about to start eating, she spoke up: "Mom, Dad, please wait a moment. I have something to tell everyone."

The four elders looked curious upon hearing this, while Yan Lin sitting next to Feng Yue seemed to think of something and suddenly went pale.

"I want to tell everyone two things." As Feng Yue spoke, she reached into her bag to take out some items.

But at this moment, Yan Lin grabbed Feng Yue's wrist under the table.

Yan Lin lowered her head, biting her lower lip tightly, then looked at Feng Yue with almost pleading eyes.

Feng Yue coldly turned her head to look at her, the determination in her gaze chilling Yan Lin to the bone.

The standoff between the two lasted only an instant. In the end, it was Yan Lin who made the concession. She released Feng Yue's hand, then slumped back against her chair like she had lost her soul, showing a defeated posture.

The four elders saw the state of the two children, and the two mothers even felt an ominous premonition.

"Nuan Nuan, what's wrong?" Lady Feng looked at her daughter with concern.

Feng Yue smiled at her, then took out the items from her bag and placed them on the table.

"The first thing I want to say is that I was diagnosed with early-stage brain cancer some time ago. I'm currently undergoing treatment, and it's nothing serious."

Although Feng Yue's tone was light enough, as soon as these words were spoken, they still caused huge waves in the small private room.

"Brain... brain cancer?"

"Nuan Nuan, don't scare Mom!"

"How could this happen! A-Lin, did you know about this too?!"

Lady Feng and Lady Yan's concerned words came one after another, and Mr. Feng even grabbed the medical report from Feng Yue's hands.

Feng Yue ignored them and immediately dropped the second bombshell: "The second thing is that I want to divorce Yan Lin."

The voices in the private room stopped abruptly, and everyone's movements ceased.

The private room fell into deathly silence.

Lady Yan opened her mouth as if wanting to say something but couldn't get anything out.

Mr. Yan, seeing his wife's anxious expression, fixed his eagle-like gaze firmly on his daughter: "You're not going to say anything at all?!"

Lady Yan nodded with a frown: "Yes, A-Lin, say something!"

"I... I don't want to divorce..." Yan Lin's eyes were slightly red, her voice no longer as calm as usual, but carried a hint of hoarseness.

Lady Feng really wanted to ask what was going on, but her daughter's health was always her primary concern.

"Sweetheart, first tell Mom what's wrong with your illness, okay?" Lady Feng's voice already carried a trace of tears.

Lady Yan was also reminded by these words to stop worrying about her disappointing daughter and focus on Feng Yue's condition instead.

Mr. Feng silently read through the entire medical report, then breathed a sigh of relief and put his arm around Lady Feng's shoulder, quietly comforting her: "It's okay, it's okay. The results on the medical report are good."

Seeing this, Feng Yue roughly explained Professor Fang's diagnosis during this period.

"That's how it is. My illness isn't very serious. As long as I maintain a good mood every day, don't get angry, keep my emotions stable, and combine that with medication, there shouldn't be any problems."

Feng Yue emphasized the words "maintain a good mood." She didn't believe Yan Lin couldn't understand the meaning in her words.

After hearing Feng Yue's explanation, the Feng couple knew they couldn't get more information by asking further. After all, they still had time to take Feng Yue for another examination. Now they needed to deal with the other matter.

Lady Feng wiped her tears and asked: "Nuan Nuan, what's this second thing about? Why do you suddenly want to divorce A-Lin?"

"Yes, sweetheart, did A-Lin bully you? Mom will help you teach her a lesson, okay?" Lady Yan nervously squeezed Mr. Yan's hand.

Feng Yue shook her head: "Yan Lin and I just have incompatible personalities, nothing else. And I'm still ill now, so it's not good to continue delaying her."

Feng Yue said the last sentence quietly, but everyone present heard it clearly.

Lady Feng and Mr. Feng almost instantly suspected that Yan Lin was disgusted by their daughter's illness, which was why she forced Feng Yue to propose divorce.

Mr. Yan, having navigated the business world for decades, immediately guessed what the two in-laws were thinking. With a stern face, he glared angrily at Yan Lin: "Yan Lin, is this your idea too?"

Yan Lin's eyes were slightly red as she looked quietly at Feng Yue, her emotions unclear. Hearing Mr. Yan's question, she didn't speak but just shook her head.

Feng Yue said nothing more, and the atmosphere in the private room became increasingly stifling.

Seeing this situation, Lady Yan couldn't help but slap Yan Lin's arm, anxious and annoyed: "You stuffy gourd⁴, say something! Your wife wants to divorce you!"

When Yan Lin was young, she had worried about Yan Lin's personality, even thinking that Yan Lin would definitely end up alone.

Later, when Feng Yue appeared beside Yan Lin, she understood that Feng Yue might be Yan Lin's only destination in this life, so she treated Feng Yue extremely well, hoping to help Yan Lin keep her.

But now, what she had feared most had still happened.

Feng Yue took a deep breath, took out a pen from her bag and placed it on the divorce agreement, pushing it toward Yan Lin.

"Since there's nothing more to say, let's sign."

Yan Lin looked at the glaring words "Divorce Agreement" in front of her, feeling strangely calm inside.

Things had reached this point. Feng Yue had given her no way out, and had given herself no way out either.

Feng Yue was determined to have this matter resolved to her satisfaction today.

"I don't want to divorce." Yan Lin lowered her eyes, looking quietly at the document in front of her, murmuring: "But you've accommodated me for a lifetime. It's time for me to make concessions... If this is what you want, I'll agree to it."

No one knew what Yan Lin meant by "a lifetime," and even Feng Yue didn't pay much attention to this suddenly appearing phrase. Her attention was completely captured by the last sentence.

Only Yan Lin knew that she was making amends - making amends for Feng Yue who had died with regrets in her previous life, making amends for Feng Yue who had suffered so much in this life.

On the day she was reborn, Yan Lin had thought about it. She didn't want Feng Yue to repeat the same mistakes, and she didn't want Feng Yue's life to end soon.

She hoped Feng Yue could focus on her treatment. If her marriage with Feng Yue was already affecting Feng Yue's recovery, then she would voluntarily leave.

She owed Feng Yue too much - so much that she could never repay it. She had no other way but to set things right and let everything start over.

If there were a thousand steps between them, then this time she would walk all thousand steps.

As long as Feng Yue would still wait for her in place.

As long as she stayed in place... that would be good...

Finally, Yan Lin reached out and grasped the pen Feng Yue handed her. The pen even carried a trace of warmth from Feng Yue's hand.

Just like the countless times she had signed contracts at the company, Yan Lin solemnly signed her name.

Except this time, it wasn't a contract, but her own divorce agreement.

Footnotes:

¹ **Songhe Bay (颂和湾)**: A fictional upscale residential area name. "Song" means praise/eulogy, "he" means harmony/peace, and "wan" means bay.

² **Nuan Nuan (囡囡)**: A term of endearment used in Shanghai dialect and surrounding regions, similar to "sweetheart" or "darling." It's commonly used by parents for their daughters.

³ **Ice mountain snow lotus:** A metaphor for someone who is beautiful but cold and aloof, like a precious flower that grows in harsh, remote mountain conditions - beautiful but untouchable.

⁴ **Stuffy gourd (闷葫芦):** A Chinese idiom describing someone who is quiet, uncommunicative, or keeps their thoughts to themselves, like a sealed gourd that makes no sound when shaken.